conservation. Simple basic operation and maintenance (O&M) could save significant amounts of this valuable resource.

60. Statement I: CORRECT—The adverse global and regional description of environment and climate change caused by anthropogenic factors is rapidly gathering momentum. The evidence is mounting that the use of factors like land, water and energy need to be altered radically, if mankind is to avoid major catastrophic climatic change. Indian agriculture is particularly fragile as it continues to depend on monsoon rains.

A significant shift in the magnitude of rains, or its timing, or its spread across the subcontinent is capable of disrupting production and supplies. Ground water reservoirs that can serve as a backup are already under stress in many parts of the country, especially in the northwest, the bread-basket of the country, Punjab and Haryana.

Statement II: CORRECT—Irregular or heavy monsoons may cause floods in agricultural fields for hundreds of miles along riverbanks. Much of the water runs off without being harvested or put to any use and causes heavy loss of life and economic resources.

The indiscriminate removal of trees, especially from mountain slopes, can cause mudslides and flashfloods in hilly regions and adjoining plains. It is estimated that more than two-fifths of the land in India suffers from one or the other features of land degradation, e.g., salinity, acidity, erosion, and waterlogging, sometimes compounded by other types of geo-genetic contaminations of water resources.

61. Statement I: CORRECT—India will be required to produce more and more from less and less land and water resources. Alarming rates of ground water depletion and serious environmental and social problems of some of the major irrigation projects on one hand, and the multiple benefits of irrigation water in enhancing production and productivity, food security, poverty alleviation.

Statement II: CORRECT—In India, water availability per capita was over 5000 cubic metres (m^3) per annum in 1950. It now stands at around 2000 m^3 and is projected to decline to 1500 m^3 by 2025. Further, the quality of available water is deteriorating.